

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner for cloud-native collaboration products.*

Positioning, ten years of end-to-end product ownership in SaaS, data platforms, and regulated environments – brought to bear on Office and Cloud Storage at STRATO.

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§ WHY STRATO

STRATO's Office and Cloud Storage products sit at the intersection of open-source infrastructure and consumer trust – a pairing I find genuinely interesting because the constraints are real: Nextcloud's ecosystem has opinions, users have expectations, and business viability demands measurable outcomes rather than feature volume. The job description calls out deep knowledge of open-source ecosystems specifically, which aligns with the technical fluency I have built across Kubernetes, GitOps, and data platform delivery. The explicit expectation of daily AI-tool usage – not as a checkbox but as a workflow – reflects how I already work. *That is exactly the environment where the work stays honest.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not previously held a product role focused on productivity and file-storage software as the primary domain. My cloud and infrastructure experience is from the platform and DevOps layer rather than end-user office tooling. The transferable mechanic is strong, however: I have repeatedly mapped complex operational workflows, owned backlog and roadmap end-to-end, and driven discovery from ambiguous requirements to shipped features in similarly technical B2B and B2C environments.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, discovery writing, PRD drafts, edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication templates, structured analysis
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted code navigation and refactoring
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototype creation for hypothesis testing
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive mockups
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready presentation decks from bullet outlines
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and process prototyping

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, JavaScript, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, Docker, Jira, Confluence.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & DEV-AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Personal infrastructure project combining a crypto backtest engine with a custom agentic developer framework.

- Builds and runs automated trading strategy backtests against historical market data with configurable execution parameters.
- Implements a file-queue-based agent loop architecture with modular task routing and LLM-assisted code generation.
- Active development repository with iterative commits across engine core, data ingestion, and agent orchestration layers.
- Demonstrates autonomous full-stack product execution – from architecture decision to working code – directly relevant to STRATO's expectation of AI-native product delivery.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT STRATO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the existing Nextcloud and Office product flows, audit the current backlog state in Jira, and hold structured one-on-ones with engineering leads in Berlin and Karlsruhe to map where delivery friction actually lives.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Take the three highest-friction backlog areas surfaced in week one and rewrite them as sprint-ready user stories with explicit acceptance criteria and KPI hooks.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Drive the first sprint to completion, instrument the delivered features against defined KPIs, and close the loop with stakeholders through a brief, structured review – building the cadence from the start.

I COVER LETTER

Dear STRATO hiring team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role on Office and Cloud Storage. I have spent the past ten years delivering product end-to-end in environments that are technically complex, stakeholder-heavy, and intolerant of vague requirements: a defence-scale AI data platform at Rohde and Schwarz, a public labour market analytics product at the Federal Employment Agency, an InsurTech SaaS platform at Emil Group, and a mobile healthcare application at CLINET Platforms. What those roles share is the pattern your job description describes: own the roadmap, manage the backlog, close the loop from discovery to KPI measurement, and hold the thread across engineering, business, and management.

The Nextcloud context is one I find technically honest. I understand open-source ecosystems from the infrastructure side – I have run Kubernetes clusters, managed GitOps rollouts with ArgoCD, and worked with REST API integrations as the product layer on top of complex backend systems. I have not managed a Nextcloud-specific product before, and I name that

clearly. What I bring is the systems fluency to get productive quickly and the discipline to prioritise learning the domain-specific nuances in the first two weeks rather than pretending they do not exist.

The AI-native workflow requirement resonates with how I already operate. At Rohde and Schwarz I used LLM-assisted development to independently deliver in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year. In my own projects I have built agentic workflow frameworks using file-queue-based agent loops, n8n automations, and Lovable for rapid prototype generation. I treat these tools as execution infrastructure, not novelty: the goal is to make hypotheses tangible faster, which is exactly the framing in your posting.

During my time at Emil Group I inherited a situation where a 17-person team had lost sprint discipline, client trust was eroding, and senior developers were leaving. I split the team, reintroduced velocity tracking, ran weekly product workshops with clients, and reduced attrition from near-total to a single departure. That experience taught me that the hard part of product ownership is not writing user stories – it is rebuilding confidence across stakeholders who have been let down, and doing so through delivery rather than promises. I would bring the same clarity-through-structure approach to the cross-site collaboration between Berlin and Karlsruhe.

I am based in Berlin, hold German citizenship, and am available within four weeks. I would be glad to talk through how my background maps to the specific product challenges you are working on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable, shipped software. Background spans AI data platforms, public analytics infrastructure, B2B SaaS, and mobile healthcare – with consistent end-to-end ownership from roadmap through KPI measurement. Fluent in agile delivery, backlog management, and cross-functional stakeholder alignment across engineering, business, and management layers. AI-native operator: daily use of LLM tooling for discovery, prototyping, documentation, and implementation support. Comfortable in technically demanding environments where requirements are incomplete and delivery pressure is real.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end product ownership from roadmap to KPI measurement
- Backlog management, sprint discipline, and velocity recovery
- AI-native workflow execution and rapid hypothesis prototyping
- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, marketing, and management
- Technical fluency: Kubernetes, REST APIs, GitOps, Python, SQL
- Translating operational complexity into sprint-ready user stories
- Client trust rebuilding in prototype-stage delivery environments
- Data-driven prioritisation with focus on measurable outcomes
- Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, cross-role ownership

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature requested from engineers for over a year
- Built central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets within the European defence programme FCAS
- Improved data quality through filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and full audit trails with data provenance
- Led cross-functional team: architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, QA

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test integration
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes; managed major system upgrades

- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Designed interactive dashboards and community features across a public-facing analytics platform

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units with ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices; regained client trust through weekly product workshops
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform

- Owned product delivery on RKI projects DIM and DESH covering secure data structures and identity management
- Delivered under strict compliance requirements in a regulated public-sector environment

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex product catalogue and API integration
- Designed and delivered customisable approval policies for B2B procurement workflows

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption modules on a quantum-secure OTP platform
- Setup flow reduced to under two minutes for non-technical users; served as deputy IT security officer
- Promoted the product to English-speaking enterprise audiences

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration and full UX/UI design
- Delivered mobile app prototype; product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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